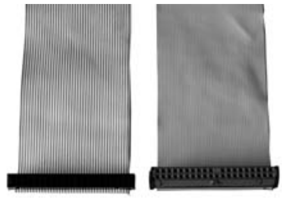
tition Manager- a free tool and excellent at that too. Go to **www.ranish.com/part** to download it.



40 pin conductor and 80 Pin conductor

▸ **Problem**: A UDMA/66 or UDMA/100 drive runs at UDMA/33 on systems that support UDMA/66 or UDMA/100.

Cause: This problem was common with IDE drives, but seldom occurs with SATA drives. The troublemaker used to be the cable that connected the drive to the motherboard.
Solution: For drives supporting UDMA/100, one needs to use an 80-pin conductor cable to make it work at its full potential. As a rule of thumb, use 80-pin conductor cables for connecting IDE drives unless the drive is older than, say, four years: back then, UDMA 33 and 66 were the *de facto* standard.

▸ **Problem**: You get an "IDE drive not ready" error at startup.
Cause: The BIOS flashes this message during startup. The problem generally occurs when the hard drive fails to spin up quickly enough.
Solution: Hard drives have mechanical components that need to attain a certain threshold rotational speed before they are ready for data transfer. There is a motherboard setting in the BIOS known as "Hard Disk Pre-delay". Activating this setting determines the amount of threshold time offered to the drive before the BIOS polls it for the requisite information. You can increase or decrease this setting with some motherboards. In most cases, increasing the hard disk pre-delay time works.

▸ **Problem**: The boot sector is corrupt.
Cause: You'll face this problem when a boot sector virus corrupts the MBR (Master Boot Record). Boot sector corruption can generally be attributed to viruses, but sometimes, tweaking the boot loader can also leave the system with a corrupt boot record.
Solution: For Windows 9x/ME and DOS, one can use the FDISK command to repair the boot sector. Boot the system from a bootable